



The AI Enterprise *Playbook*

A leader's guide to building
your AI Operator workforce

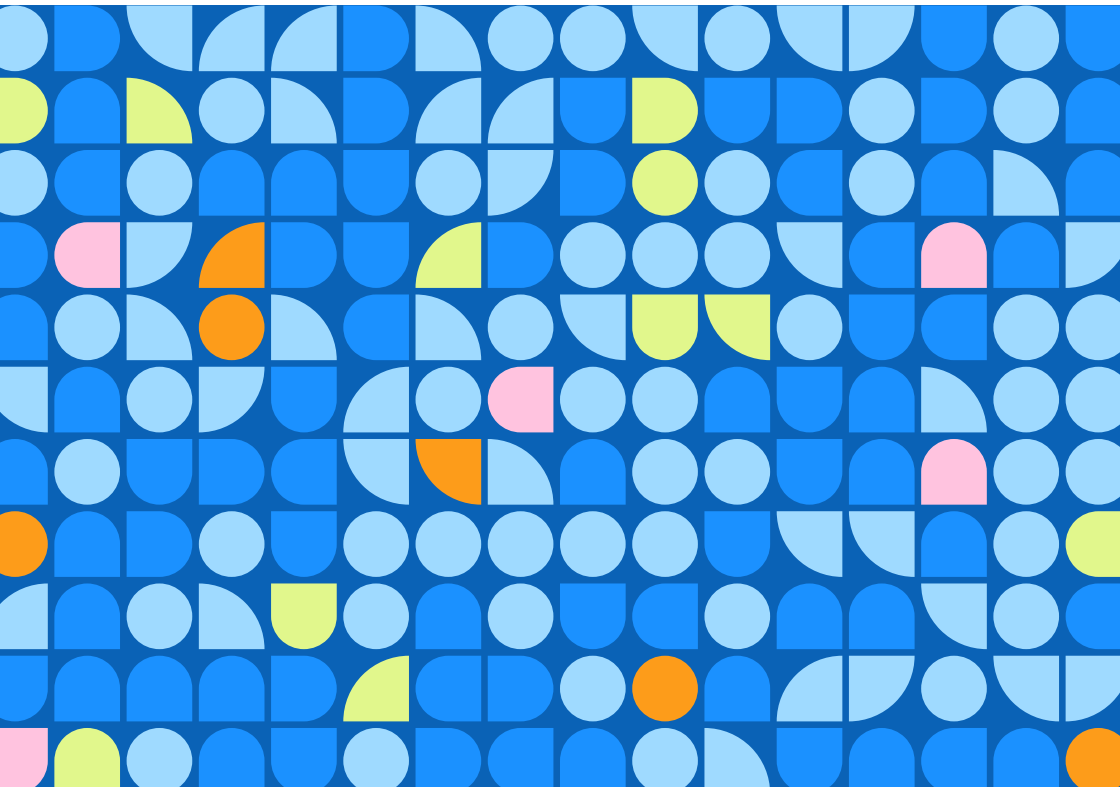


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Opening

A Note from the Founders

Gabriel Hubert & Stanislas Polu, *Co-founders, Dust*

We didn't set out to build a productivity tool.

The first version of Dust came from a simple frustration: we kept watching brilliant teams work in isolation. An insight discovered by one person would die in a Slack thread. A process figured out by one team would never reach the next. Organizations were getting smarter tools and staying, stubbornly, the same kind of organization.

The last two years taught us something that isn't obvious at first: the bottleneck was never the model. The gap between "AI adoption" and "AI transformation" isn't a technology gap. It's a structural gap. And the people who close it aren't the ones with the most compute or the best prompts. They're the ones who understood early that AI is not a tool you hand to an individual. It's the infrastructure you build for an organization.

That's the insight behind what we call the AI Operator. They're not a new job title. They're a new mindset that was always waiting to emerge. The person in RevOps who started rebuilding their pipeline workflow from scratch, assuming AI exists. The compliance analyst who stopped waiting for engineers and started building the agent herself. The support lead who turned their team's institutional knowledge into something that compounds instead of evaporates. They've been there all along. AI just gave them something to build with.

And this is something we're incredibly proud to witness every day, concretely, inside companies building with Dust. At 1Password, Assembled, Clay, Criteo, Cursor, Datadog, Decagon, Persona, Vanta, Watershed, Whatnot and many others, these operators have already changed how their organizations work. You'll hear directly from them in the pages ahead.

This playbook is our attempt to put their experience into words: to give language to what they've been doing, so that more leaders can recognize them, more organizations can empower them, and more teams can feel what it's like when the organization itself gets smarter.

We're sharing this at a moment when the AI market is moving fast, faster than many companies can absorb. New models, new interfaces, new buzzwords every quarter. If this creates noise for you, we hope this book creates signal. Not about what's possible in a demo, but about what's sustainable in an organization. Not about the technology, but about the architecture of work.

The companies that will matter in five years aren't necessarily the ones deploying AI the earliest. They're the ones building the right foundation, where knowledge compounds, where humans and AI work as peers, and where every new capability stands on everything that came before.

We call this collaborative intelligence. And the rise of the AI Operator is how it happens.

Thank you for reading.

Gabriel & Stanislas



"Before your company becomes AI-enabled, your employees first have to become AI-native."



Michael Sungwoo Yang
AI Operations Manager



DATADOG

Interlude

Voices from the Field

Dispatches from leaders and AI operators mid-shift. What the change looks like from inside the companies making it.

A pattern worth naming

Across every company in this book, a few things hold true:

The shift started with one or two people who didn't wait for permission. The inflection point was when AI moved from "personal productivity" to "team infrastructure."

The metric that surprised leaders most wasn't time saved. It was who started building. The question for your organization isn't whether AI will change how you work. It already is. The question is whether you're building the foundation that makes the change compound, or layering new tools on old architecture and wondering why the needle isn't moving.

Assembled

"We made a bet on Dust because we knew the team was exceptional. What we didn't expect was how quickly it would transform how we work."

Dust became the connective tissue that amplifies what each team does best."



Ryan Wang

CEO at Assembled

Doctolib

"We asked ourselves for years: what if your team had 20% more time? Dust has made it possible, empowering our employees to work smarter, innovate, and push boundaries."



Matthieu Birach

Chief People Officer

Qonto



"Dust is the most impactful software we've adopted since building Clay."



Everett Berry

Head of GTM Engineering



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"My background is in AI and deeply technical. So when I got to Vanta and heard about Dust, I was convinced it wasn't going to work. But now I'm a full believer. I've been converted."

We used to do the work. Now we build the agents that do it."



Shashank Khanna

Founder in Residence of GTM Innovation

CURSOR

Back Market

"This is a clear example of how Dust enables domain experts to become AI builders."

They are able to solve their own problems with generative AI without relying on engineering resources, which are always a little bit restricted in terms of bandwidth."



Aurélien Gervasi

AI Engineering Manager



"When you have a tool like Dust that can serve as a sandbox to build what you might otherwise buy, and it can benefit the entire company while meeting security requirements, the decision becomes obvious."



Axel Demazy

CEO at Spendsk



My entire career was built on systems thinking — distributed infrastructure, zero-trust architecture. When my CTO mentioned Dust at our offsite, I rolled my



1

The Shift

Why AI needs Operators

In 2024, your company bought AI to make employees more productive. In 2026, tokens cost money. You need people with the craft to use AI well, and you need that AI to change how your whole organization works: how knowledge moves between teams, how one person's improvement lifts everyone.

There's a difference. And that difference is where competitive advantage lives.

Most enterprise AI conversations fixate on individual productivity gains. The real transformation is different: it's about how work moves between people, between teams, between humans and AI.

Companies deploying AI hit a ceiling: People get faster. The organization stays the same speed.

Why? They're stuck in **single-player mode when the game should be multiplayer.**

Single-player vs. multiplayer AI

Single-player AI

Each person has their own AI assistants or agents. Insights stay isolated. Improvements don't spread. Knowledge fragments across tools and teams.

Multiplayer AI

Humans and AI collaborate together. Agents work with humans and other agents. Knowledge compounds. The organization learns as a system.

The distinction matters for how you allocate resources. Single-player AI scales with headcount: every new hire needs their own setup, their own context, their own learning curve. Multiplayer AI scales with usage.

It matters for how you buy, too. Features are converging: most AI products are racing toward the same capabilities. The system underneath is where they split, and most systems are still built for someone working alone.

The next person/agent to use a well-built system gets more value than the first, because the system has learned from every interaction in between. Most AI budgets are still structured around the first model. The organizations breaking through have shifted to the second.



What this playbook covers

A new framework for what enterprise AI actually means: not better tools for individuals, but collaborative intelligence infrastructure that makes your entire organization more capable.

Who this is for

You're a decision-maker at your company and you believe **AI will fundamentally rewire how your organization operates**. You've moved past 'should we use AI?' to 'how do we make AI transform how we work?'

You've probably:

- Deployed Claude, Microsoft Copilot, ChatGPT Enterprise, or Gemini, and saw adoption and productivity gains
- Tried enterprise search tools like Glean to unify your knowledge base; useful for finding information, but it stops at retrieval
- Built custom agents or workflows that work in pockets but aren't spreading
- Hit questions like: "How do we scale beyond early adopters?", "What's the ROI?", "How to control our token costs?" or "Why isn't this creating the transformation we expected?"

Most enterprise AI guidance was written for two extremes: companies with 18-month transformation budgets, or individuals looking for productivity hacks. You're at a company (500 to 10,000 employees) that needs enterprise-grade AI without enterprise overhead. You need AI that rewires how teams work and how knowledge compounds.

Behind every company that's broken through the AI ceiling, there are people we call **AI Operators**:

Builders who stopped treating AI as a tool and started treating it as an operating principle. They come from ops, product, revops, support, analytics, legal, HR, or somewhere you didn't expect. They're the ones who look at a quarterly process and ask: **“what if we rebuilt this assuming AI exists?”**



AI Operators are emerging in every organization. As a leader, the question isn't whether they exist. It's whether you've identified them, whether you're giving them room to build, and whether your organization is structured to multiply their impact. This playbook will help you understand what they need and how to measure whether you have enough of them.

Key insight



The companies pulling away aren't using better AI. They're using AI that collaborates differently, with humans, with other AI, across teams, in ways that make organizational intelligence compound over time. This is about architecture, organization, and communication. Not just tools.



2 The three waves of Enterprise AI

*In 1987, **Robert Solow** observed that 'you can see the computer age everywhere but in the productivity statistics.' Companies had spent billions on IT. Individual workers were clearly faster. But aggregate productivity was flat, and stayed flat for another decade. The resolution wasn't a better computer. It was the slow, unglamorous work of redesigning organizations around what the technology made possible.*

Enterprise AI is in the same chapter of the same story. Your teams adopted copilots and agents. Individual output improved. But the organizational needle hasn't moved, because the architecture of work hasn't changed yet.

Wave 1

Enterprise search (2015–2023)

The first wave was about finding things. The "where did someone document that?" problem. Every company has one. AI made tribal knowledge searchable, like a Google for your company.

It solved real problems: reduced time hunting for information, connected disparate data sources (Slack, Notion, Drive, Sharepoint, Confluence), and made onboarding faster.

"We made knowledge more findable. We didn't make it more usable."

Wave 2

Conversational AI and LLM assistants (2022–2025)

Wave 2 gave AI a voice, but not hands. Chat with AI like a colleague. Draft documents, summarize meetings, translate content. A personal productivity multiplier.

But this is where most companies are stuck. Three traps define the ceiling:

1. The verticalization trap

Teams deploy different AI tools: Sales uses Tool A, Marketing uses Tool B, Support uses Tool C; each walled off from the rest. What one team learns stays with that team.

Email became essential infrastructure because everyone was on the same system. Most companies are building AI the opposite way.

2. The crowd problem

Everyone has their own AI assistant or agent, but they don't talk to each other.

Sales AI doesn't know what Customer Success learned. Marketing insights don't flow to Product. Each conversation stays isolated and improvements don't spread.

3. The entropy trap

Every team builds custom agents, skills, prompts, workflows. Knowledge fragments across dozens of custom GPTs or hundreds of Copilot agents. The more you build, the more fragmented it becomes and marginal complexity keeps growing.



Key insight

Wave 2 makes individuals smarter but doesn't make the organization smarter. It's single-player AI in a world that should be multiplayer.

Wave 3

Collaborative intelligence systems (2025+)

This isn't 'better search' or 'smarter chat.' It's fundamentally different architecture.

The best human teams don't just work in parallel. They coordinate through shared objectives, awareness of what teammates are doing, and moving in cohesion. Wave 3 brings that dynamic to how humans and AI collaborate.

Three defining characteristics:

1. Agent-to-agent, human-to-agent and human-to-human collaboration

AI agents collaborate with each other, with individual humans, and with multiple humans. Work flows between agents and humans like it flows between team members. Agents can ping humans just as humans ping agents.

In practice:

- specialized agents you @mention the way you'd loop in a teammate who's already done the research. They're always available and their knowledge updates automatically.
- Sub-agents spawn other agents for multi-step workflows.
- Skills serve as shared capabilities any agent can invoke.
- Projects become hubs where humans, agents, context, and goals converge to collaborate and build together.

2. Write actions, not just read

AI agents don't just retrieve information; they execute. Update a CRM, send an email, create a document, trigger a workflow. Every action is permission-aware and gated by stakes: low-risk tasks run autonomously, high-stakes ones require human approval.

3. Shared foundation that grows (agents that learn)

Knowledge and learning don't stay trapped in individual agents. Two motions create compounding:

- **Coalescence:** Best practices from scattered agents consolidate into reusable building blocks
- **Diffusion:** Those building blocks spread to every agent and human that needs them

Unlike traditional AI that's static after deployment, collaborative intelligence and multiplayer AI creates a learning layer: agents observe how work gets done, identify successful patterns, surface suggestions to AI Operators for review. Operators validate and deploy what works, and improvements ripple to every agent that could benefit.

Agents suggest, operators decide what ships. The system learns how your organization works, but every recommendation is visible before anything goes live: operators see it, review it, approve it or kill it.

Result



Each new workflow is more efficient and gets easier to build, not because complexity disappears, but because shared foundations absorb more of it. Humans stay in control of what becomes organizational infrastructure.

How the underlying assumptions have shifted



The market hasn't fully shifted to Wave 3. What's changed isn't the technology alone; it's the assumptions about how AI creates value.

Wave	Core assumption	Optimization	What it misses
 Search (Wave 1)	Knowledge should be findable	Information retrieval	Can't act, can't learn, can't compound
 Assistants (Wave 2)	Individuals should be faster	Personal productivity	Organization doesn't get smarter
 Collaborative intelligence (Wave 3)	Organizations should compound	Systemic capability	Still emerging; requires AI x human collaboration, AI operators and architecture

The reframe



Not 'which AI tool?' but 'which AI infrastructure?' Not 'individual productivity' but 'organizational transformation.' Not 'single-player' but 'multiplayer.'



3 What companies mistake for success

High adoption doesn't mean transformation: the early numbers reflect genuine progress.

But look at the distribution. Most usage clusters around basic tasks: summarization, Q&A, translation. The workflows that would actually reshape how an organization operates require a different level of craft from the people using them. And as token costs become a real line item, the distance between broad adoption and effective adoption starts to matter.



The platform for AI operators

Good use of AI requires practice and craft, not just access to tools. It requires an AI Operator mindset:

- ✓ The ability to identify new use cases and new ways of building systems.
- ✓ Generalist profiles who can go deep, from ops, compliance, support, RevOps, or product, are particularly valuable in pushing AI adoption forward.

Why individual gains don't automatically scale

- Local optimization can create more noise overall (everyone working faster in isolation)
- Improvements don't spread (what works for one person stays with one person)
- Knowledge fragments across tools and teams
- No compounding effect

Productivity gains (necessary)	Transformational change (sufficient)
Individual task acceleration	Organizational capability expansion
Time saved (hours/week)	Work that wasn't possible before
Additive improvement	Multiplicative compounding
Linear gains that plateau	Accelerating gains from network effects
Local optimization	System-level transformation

The question that matters

If we removed AI tomorrow, would our organization's structure and processes be unchanged? Or would removing AI break workflows that now define how we operate?

Three things to check:

What are people using it for? Mostly summarization and Q&A — or workflows where one person's output feeds another's?

What breaks if you turn it off? "People would be annoyed" is a productivity tool. "We'd need to rebuild three processes" is infrastructure.

Who is building? Count the people creating agents and designing workflows. That's your real transformation signal.



4

Core capabilities of collaborative intelligence

Collaborative intelligence isn't only about smarter individual tools. It's about creating an organizational nervous system where information flows, humans and AI work as peers, and knowledge compounds.

Multi-specialized-agent collaboration

Most AI platforms look similar in a demo. The system underneath is where they diverge to ease collaboration by design:

Model-agnostic. Each agent runs whatever model fits its task. When a better model ships, you swap it in without rebuilding.

Open ecosystem. Agents connect to your existing tools and work where your people already work: Slack, Notion, Salesforce, GitHub, your own tools.

Shared knowledge layer. Every agent draws from the same organizational context. What one agent surfaces is available to every other.

Decoupled governance. Agents don't inherit user permissions. Each has its own access scope, defined by the data Spaces it's assigned to, independent of who's using it.

This architecture is what makes agents composable in practice:

- **@mention** agents the way you'd loop in a colleague who's done the research
- **Sub-agents** delegate to specialists for multi-step workflows
- **Skills** share capabilities across teams and are self-learning
- **Projects** bring humans, agents, and context together on specific initiatives

Observability and trust

Trust in collaborative intelligence requires transparency: authorship tracking (what AI created vs. what humans created), human curation markers, audit trails, version history.

At first, you trust agents because you trust the people who created them. Over time, you trust agents because you can see their track record.

In practice: from manual to multiplayer

Traditional customer qualification:

Rep manually gathers company data, checks criteria, updates CRM, routes to appropriate colleague. Takes 30+ minutes per lead, inconsistent quality.

With collaborative intelligence:

Rep @mentions qualification agent in a project. Agent pulls data via enrichment skill, checks criteria via qualification skill, updates CRM via integration tool, routes appropriately via workflow skill. All actions logged with clear authorship markers. Under 2 minutes, consistent, learns from every interaction.

Not one bloated agent trying to do everything. Multiple specialized agents collaborating through shared skills, with full transparency.

This is how Clay, the data enrichment platform, scaled their GTM Engineering team 4x with Dust, achieving 100% team adoption and saving 58 hours monthly.

Fifty-eight hours saved monthly is the visible metric. The deeper shift is that Clay's knowledge base now improves every time anyone uses it. Next quarter's number will be higher without additional investment. That compounding dynamic is what separates infrastructure from tools.

Cross-functional knowledge compounding

This is the exponential unlock.

Two motions create compounding:

Coalescence (knowledge moves inward): Teams build capabilities independently. Best practices emerge from real usage. The system identifies patterns worth formalizing. Excellence consolidates into shared skills.

Diffusion (knowledge spreads outward): Shared skills available to any agent. Update once, improvement spreads everywhere. New agents inherit the full foundation. Marginal cost of each new capability approaches zero.

The horizontal advantage

This is where a horizontal, tool-agnostic approach becomes crucial. Not verticalized, not 'AI for sales' separate from 'AI for support' separate from 'AI for finance.' One collaborative intelligence layer across all teams and tools. An abstraction layer that creates intelligent tissue connecting your entire organization, regardless of underlying systems.



Contrast with workflow automation

Traditional automation (like n8n, Gumloop) thinks in arrows and boxes: if this, then that. Rigid, predetermined flows. Adding capability means adding complexity.

Collaborative intelligence thinks in context and skills: agents that reason about situations, flexible and adaptive responses. Adding capability means enriching foundation, not adding more spaghetti.



Good use of AI requires practice and craft, not just access to tools

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Creative Force, an end-to-end content management platform, saw new hires reach full productivity 40% faster after deploying collaborative AI across their organization.



The strategic implication

Companies with this infrastructure build capabilities exponentially faster than competitors starting from scratch each time. Your 50th workflow is easier than your 5th because shared foundation has grown.

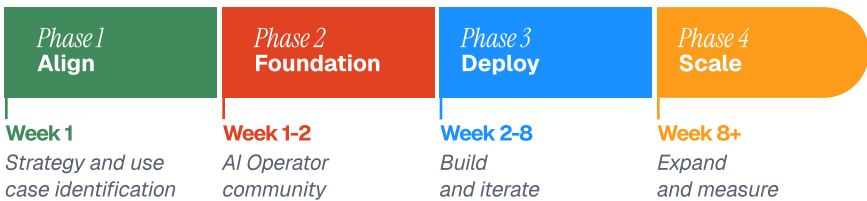


5 Implementation framework

You understand the vision.

Now: how do you actually build this?

The framework spans four phases, typically a few weeks to three months depending on company size, with ongoing optimization.



Finding the right use cases

Don't pick one isolated use case. Pick one use case per team, across at least 3 teams. This reveals what's reusable vs. team-specific, tests whether solutions scale, builds shared foundation from day one, and creates momentum across the organization.

Three lenses for identifying strong use cases

1. The Anti-To-Do List.

Tasks you no longer need to focus on:

- ✓ Monitoring KPIs and alerting on changes
- ✓ Tracking competitors and market signals
- ✓ Every time you do something annoying, ask "How can I not have to do this again?"

2. Skill bottlenecks

Where work slows when employees hit the limits of their expertise:

- ✓ Data analysis when you're not an analyst
- ✓ Trend visualization when you're not a designer
- ✓ Legal review when you're not a lawyer.
Where do people wait for experts from other departments?

3. Build new ideas

Unblock thinking and kickstart creation:

- ✓ Brainstorm campaign ideas with instant feedback
- ✓ Look for quick insights in raw data
- ✓ Analyze trends without waiting for analysts.
Where do people stare at blank pages?

Characteristics of strong first use cases

- Aligned with a company objective; supports strategic priority, not just 'nice to have'
- Understandable by the Operator; if they can't understand the problem, they can't test quality
- Currently time-consuming or frustrating; clear before/after, motivated team
- Highly repetitive; compounding is obvious
- Involves 2-3+ people minimum; build trust through collaboration, not isolation

Creative Force, an end-to-end content management platform, saw new hires reach full productivity 40% faster after deploying collaborative AI across their organization.

Phase 1

Align on strategy

Week 1

Document 3-5 use cases across at least 3 teams
(current pain, desired outcome, success metrics, team involved)

- ✓ Prioritize using effort/value framework
- ✓ Connect to business strategy:
which use cases support strategic priorities?
- ✓ Build core team: executive sponsor, program lead,
3-5 AI Operators from across the org, admin/IT
- ✓ Define success criteria and realistic timeline

Phase 2

Align on strategy

Week 1-2

Every organization that's made collaborative intelligence work has identified and empowered AI Operators: people who sit between strategy and execution, from RevOps, operations, compliance, support, product, or engineering. You don't need to hire for this. You need to recognize them. They're already tinkering, already building. Your job is to give them mandate, visibility, and a shared foundation to build on.

- ✓ **Create an AI Operator hub:** dedicated Slack channel, regular meetups (weekly initially), knowledge sharing space
- ✓ **Initial training:** how to build agents, use skills and tools, test quality, gather feedback and iterate
- ✓ **Observability best practices:** authorship tracking, curation markers

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- ✓ **Observability best practices:** authorship tracking, curation markers

Deliverable by end of Phase 2

- 3-5 AI Operators trained and ready to build
- Operator community hub established
- 3-5 target use cases identified and prioritized across 3+ teams
- Workspace setup complete

Phase 3

Build, deploy, iterate

Week 2-8

Document 3-5 use cases across at least 3 teams
(current pain, desired outcome, success metrics, team involved)

W 2-4 Operators create 2-3 agents per use case. Keep agents specialized. Make them action-capable from day one. Use shared skills where appropriate. Set up observability.

W 2-6 Daily usage and rapid iteration. Agents live where work happens (Slack, email, team tools, Projects). Quick fixes daily, weekly reviews of what's working and spreading.

W 2-4 Measure quantitative metrics (time saved, usage rates, quality).
Capture qualitative insights:

W 6-8 Prioritize using effort/value framework

'What can you do now that you couldn't before?'

'Would you be sad if you couldn't use this anymore?'

Phase 4

Scale and optimize

Week 8+

Compound. What worked for one team becomes foundation for the next.

W 8-10 **Extract:** universal logic into shared skills. Build cross-team agents where workflows connect. Spread the improvements that ripple.

W 10-12 **Expand:** 2–3 new teams join, each on the shared foundation plus team-specific needs. Pilot Operators mentor the new wave.

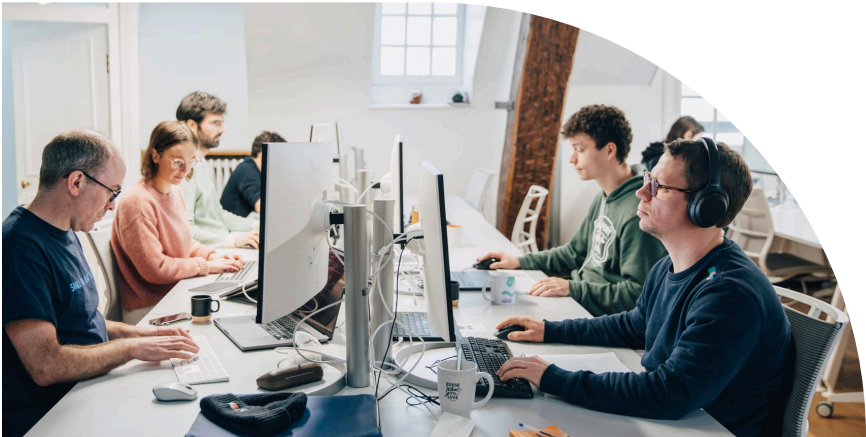
W 12+ **Operate:** Monthly Operator meetups · quarterly leadership reviews on transformation metrics · continuous feedback · governance that grows with scale.

The compounding effect becomes visible

Second wave of agents built faster than first. Improvements in one domain lift others automatically. Marginal complexity of new agents decreases. Foundation gets richer without getting more complex.

Long-term vision (3-6 months):

- ✅ **20-50+ agents** across the organization
- ✅ **10-20** shared skills
- ✅ **Knowledge compounding visible**; improvements spread automatically
- ✅ **New hires onboard** to 'work includes AI' (not 'here's an AI tool to try')
- ✅ If you removed AI, workflows would break; **it's infrastructure now**



The compounding effect becomes visible



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6 Measuring success

Measuring AI's impact is harder than it looks, and the difficulty is itself informative. When Robert Solow noted that computers were everywhere except the productivity statistics, the problem wasn't that IT was failing. It was that the metrics hadn't caught up to the reorganization underway. If your existing KPIs don't show AI impact yet, the question is whether you're measuring the right things.

Before measuring anything, answer: What are your strategic priorities? How would AI supporting those priorities show up? What metrics do your executives already care about?

Framework 1: **Internal satisfaction and sentiment**

If people don't value it, it's not working, regardless of metrics.

"Would you be sad if you couldn't use this anymore?"

Framework 2: **Time and capacity measurement**

For each use case, compare before and after: how long does it take today? How often is it performed? New time required? Quality different?

Qualified lead example



Before: 30 min/lead x 100 leads/week x 5 AEs = 250 hours/week.
After: 5 min/lead = 42 hours/week.
Impact: 208 hours/week = 5.2 FTE capacity unlocked.

Framework 3:
Organizational capability and strategic impact

Run the 'remove AI tomorrow' test. Track what new work is now enabled, how fast work moves between teams, how many agents share common skills, and how quickly improvements spread.

Framework 4:
The economic Turing test

Assess AI like you'd assess an employee. 'If this were a person, would you hire them? Promote them? Give them more responsibility?' Rate on reliability, speed, quality, learning, collaboration, scope. Compare to human benchmark. Track progression over time.

Your priority	Recommended frameworks
Proving ROI for budget	Time/capacity + Strategic impact
Scaling adoption	Satisfaction + Economic Turing test
Board/exec reporting	Capability/strategic + Quantitative backup
Operational improvement	Efficiency + Quality assessment

Start simple, add depth over time: Week 1-4 basic satisfaction and usage. Week 4-12 time savings and task completion. Month 3-6 new capabilities and strategic impact. Month 6+ knowledge compounding and competitive advantage.

Operator density: the metric only you can track

Beyond the frameworks above, there's a leading indicator that no dashboard will surface for you. Look across your teams and ask: how many people have moved from using AI as a personal productivity tool to building systems that make their entire team better? These are your AI Operators.

Your operator density is the ratio of AI Operators to AI users across your organization. It's the leading indicator that sits upstream of every other metric in this section. Time saved, capability gained, organizational intelligence: they all flow from having enough Operators who've made the shift from individual productivity to systemic design.

This isn't a ranking exercise. It's a resource allocation question. Building with AI is a practiced craft, and organizations with more practitioners compound faster than organizations with more licenses. Your job as a leader is to know your operator density, and to raise it.



7 The path forward

The Solow Paradox resolved when organizations stopped layering new technology on old processes and committed to redesigning the work itself. That redesign was driven by people inside the organization who understood both the technology and the work. The IT revolution needed its operators.

The AI revolution needs them too. The strategic question isn't whether to invest in AI. It's whether you're investing in your AI Operators: the people and the architecture that turn adoption into organizational intelligence. Your role is to find them, resource them, and track whether their ranks are growing.

What to do next

If you're just starting

- ✓ identify your AI Operators across at least 3 teams (who understands workflows + has curiosity?)
- ✓ Give them the three lenses:
Anti-To-Do List, Skill bottlenecks, Build new ideas
- ✓ Pick one use case per team, across 3+ teams; start building week 1

If you're scaling existing AI:

- ✓ Run the 'remove AI tomorrow' test: would workflows break?
- ✓ Empower your Operators to extract shared skills and enable cross-team collaboration
- ✓ Measure your operator density: is it growing or stalling?

If you're transforming your organization:

- ✓ Measure beyond individual productivity: what capabilities exist now that didn't before?
- ✓ Invest in your Operators as a talent strategy, not just a project allocation
- ✓ Track the compounding: is your 50th workflow easier than your 5th?

Whatever stage you're at, the first diagnostic is the same: find your AI Operators, ask whether you're doing enough to support them, and measure whether their number is growing.

The gap between AI adoption and AI impact will keep widening. The companies that close it first won't be the ones with the best models. They'll be the ones who invested in their AI Operators and gave them the room to rewire how the organization works.



The AI operating system for the enterprise

Dust.tt

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